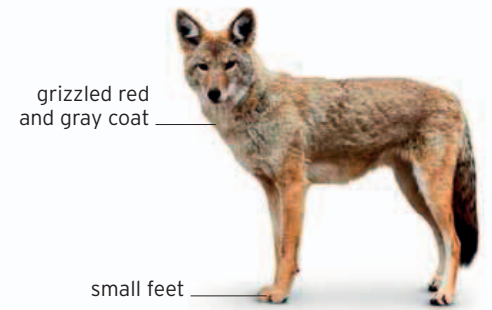




# Coyote

*Canis latrans*

Most wild dog species face enormous pressure from humans encroaching on their wide-ranging habitats. However, the coyote is thriving, even encroaching on human habitats as a proficient poacher of poultry and scavenger of human garbage.

Somewhere between a fox and wolf in size, the coyote has a highly adaptable lifestyle. Although it may form packs to hunt large animals such as deer, mostly it is a solitary hunter, targeting smaller prey—such as prairie dogs—alone. Coyotes spend the day in an underground den; they may dig their own den, but usually enlarge one abandoned by badgers or ground squirrels.

## Involved parenting

When raising offspring, coyotes set out their home ranges by marking bushes and other landmarks with urine and feces. They assert their claim on the territory with loud yips and howls. Coyotes may form pair bonds that last several years. Mating occurs in late winter, and about six pups are born two months later. Both parents nourish the youngsters with regurgitated food in the den.

## Coyotes work with American badgers to hunt burrowing rodents

### < HOWLING COYOTE

Coyotes are noisy animals, frequently howling to lay claim to a territory or greet a family member.

- ↔ 29–37 in (74–94 cm)
- ⚖ 17–35 lb (7.7–15.9 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🦋 Mammals, insects, fruit
- 🏠



North America  
and N. Central America